

Lesson 2.22: Education Roadmap and Career Research Card, and the Unit 2 Test

Unit: Unit 2, Me, My Goals, My Money (Individual Growth and Life Readiness) **Topic:** 2.5 Work and Careers **Grade:** 6 to 8 (written at grade 7; see Differentiation for the grade 6 support and grade 8 stretch) **Days:** 1 class period of 40 minutes (14 minutes careers, 10 minutes final trading window, 15 minutes Unit 2 Test, 1 minute closure) **Room:** Either (classroom or FACS lab; devices for the trading window and, if available, for career research)

Standards

- NYS module line: NYS IGLR 5. Career Pathways a) Explore various careers within the 16 national career clusters
- NYS module line: NYS IGLR 3. Employability d) Explore and implement strategies for career readiness
- CTE theme line: CTE CCO 4. Career Plans a) Examine potential career choices to determine knowledge, skills, and abilities associated with each
- CTE theme line: CTE CCO 4. Career Plans b) Assess personal characteristics such as interests, abilities, and aptitudes in relation to characteristics associated with careers of interest
- NYS FACS Learning Standard 3 (Intermediate), Key Idea: Students will understand and be able to manage personal resources of talent, time, energy, and money and make effective decisions in order to balance their obligations to work, family, and self.; Performance Indicator: Students identify their own abilities and interests as possible guides to career choice.
- CDOS Standard 1 Career Development: Students will be knowledgeable about the world of work, explore career options, and relate personal skills, aptitudes, and abilities to future career decisions.
- National FCS 3.0: 1.2.1 Examine possible careers to find what each one requires and offers in knowledge, skills, attitudes, and openings.
- National FCS 3.0: 1.1.6 Build a life plan that lays out how to gain what a person must know and be able to do to reach personal, family, and career goals.

Note on CCO 4. c) (the NYS Career Plan format): the task named a), b), and c) and asked for two. This lesson cites a) and b). Line c) belongs to Unit 7, where students fill a full career plan; today's research card is one career, not a plan.

Enduring understanding and essential question

Big idea: There is more than one road after high school, and the fastest road is not always the cheapest and the longest is not always the best. A career decision is a decision like any other: name the choice, list the options, weigh them against what matters. **Essential question:** How much school is worth it, and who gets to decide that for you?

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

1. (Low) Given the six paths after high school (a job with on-the-job training, an apprenticeship, a certificate program, a two-year degree, a four-year degree, the military), describe each in one sentence and name one job that usually takes that path.
2. (Mid) Using a career resource, complete a research card for one career from their top three clusters: main tasks, education path, pay range, a day in the life, and the source.
3. (High) Judge whether the researched career fits their top three, their two interest letters, and their values from Topic 2.1, and write a two-sentence verdict that gives a reason for and a reason against.

Vocabulary

Tier 2 (general academic): path, source, verdict, range Tier 3 (FACS): apprenticeship, certificate, associate degree, bachelor's degree, on-the-job training. See the unit vocabulary list for the Spanish column.

Materials and setup

- Handout, one per student: Handout 02.22 - Career Research Card and Pathways.md (the six paths table on the front, the research card on the back, one worked example)
- A career resource: devices open to the state's career exploration site or the federal occupational outlook site, or a printed one-page career sheet for each of the 24 most-chosen careers
- Each student's match sheet from Lesson 2.21 (top three), the two letters from the Lesson 2.2 interest quiz, and the Investor Journal (Handout 02.14 - Investor Journal.md) open to the Round 2 lines
- Devices and today's dispatch for the final Round 2 window block (windows 55 to 60); this is the last window of the Investor Challenge, so the leaderboard freezes at the reset cue
- The Unit 2 Test, one per student: Assessment 02.2 - Unit 2 Test.md; calculators for item 16 only
- Slides: Slides 02.22 - Education Roadmap and Career Research Card and Unit 2 Test
- Timer visible; the test timer is on the screen
- Setup notes: write the do now on the board. Put the six-paths slide up. Print the tests the day before and keep them face down until Step 4. Tell students the day before that the test is today and what it covers (all five topics, 20 items, 15 minutes).

Pre-assessment

The do now asks students to guess the school needed for three jobs. Most guess "college" for all three. The gap between the guess and the six-paths table is the lesson. For the test, the four topic checks (All About Me, the goal plan, the Money Basics Quiz, the Investor Report) already told you which topic each class is weakest in; the review slide at the start of Step 4 hits that topic.

Do now and hook (Time: 2 min)

On the board: “What do you have to do after high school to become (a) a nurse, (b) an electrician, (c) a teacher? Write your best guess for each. One line each.”

Debrief: hands up for “college for all three.” Then the hook: “One of those three can start earning money the summer after graduation and finish training with no student loans. Today you find out which, and you find the road for one of your own top three.”

Procedure

Step	Teacher will	Students will	Time
1. Direct instruction: six paths after high school	Show the six paths on one slide with the usual years and who pays: a job with on-the-job training; an apprenticeship (paid to learn, three to five years); a certificate program (weeks to a year); a two-year degree (associate); a four-year degree (bachelor's); the military (paid training and a job). Answer the do now: nurse is a two-year or four-year degree plus a license; electrician is an apprenticeship; teacher is a four-year degree plus a state certificate. Say the rule: “More school is not automatically better or worse. It is a trade of years and money for the job you want. That is a decision, and you have a model for decisions.”	Fill the six-paths table on the handout: one sentence and one job for each path.	4 min
2. Learning activity: the career research	Hand out the research card. Each	Research one career and fill the card:	8 min

card	student picks one career from their top three clusters (from the Lesson 2.21 match sheet) and opens the career resource. Walk the worked example on the handout once (a fictional student researching “dental hygienist”). Circulate; the field students skip is “a day in the life,” which is the field that changes minds. Say that pay ranges on any sheet go out of date because pay changes every year and the year of the source must be written down.	main tasks (three), education path (one of the six), pay range and the year of the source, a day in the life (three lines), the source, and the verdict: does it fit my top three, my two letters, and my values, with one reason for and one against. Finish at home if needed.	
3. ClassroomStreet final trading window (Round 2, windows 55 to 60)	Open the last window block. Post the final dispatch. At 10 minutes, close the window with the reset cue and freeze the leaderboard. Say only: “Round 2 standings go up tomorrow.”	Read, decide, trade or hold for the last time, and write the Round 2, Day 3 line in the Investor Journal. Close the device and clear the desk for the test.	10 min
4. Unit 2 Test	Hand out the test face down. Read the directions once. Calculators out for item 16 only. Show the one review slide (three lines on the class’s weakest topic) for 30 seconds, then start the timer for 15 minutes. Collect at	Take the test.	15 min

	the bell. Collect the research cards that are done; the rest come in tomorrow as the do now.		
--	--	--	--

Questions to ask

Monitor understanding:

- Which path pays you while you learn? Which one takes the longest?
- A career sheet says “typical entry-level education: postsecondary nondegree award.” Which of the six paths is that?
- What is missing from a card that has pay and education but no “day in the life”?

Deepen learning:

- The electrician starts earning at 18 and the nurse at 22. Who has more money at 30? What would you need to know to answer that?
- Your career fits your two letters but not your values. Which one wins? Is that a five-step decision?
- What would you tell a friend who says “I am going to college” but cannot name a job at the end of it?

Check for understanding

During Step 2, a two-column clipboard check: “chose a career from the top three” and “found the education path on the source (not guessed).” Both yeses means the student is on track for a complete card. A student with a guessed path gets pointed to the line on the career sheet where it is printed.

Closure (Time: 1 min)

Collect the tests. As students pass them forward, one line on a sticky note stuck to the research card: “The thing from this unit I will use first is ____.” Read two aloud tomorrow with the Round 2 standings. (The unit’s last word is the Round 2 standings and the journal lines in the first 10 minutes of Unit 3 Day 1; see the unit plan.)

Differentiation and supports

- ELL: the six paths on the slide have one picture each (a hard hat, a tool belt, a certificate, a two-year calendar, a four-year calendar, a uniform); the path names and the research card headings are in Spanish on the handout (see Vocabulary 02.md); the career resource has a Spanish version; the test has a word bank on the matching items and reads at grade 6; a bilingual dictionary is allowed on the test.
- IEP and 504 (general): the research card may be completed with a partner on the same career, each writing their own verdict; extended time on the test by finishing it during tomorrow’s do now; the test can be read aloud in a small group; fewer items (see the grade 6 note on the key).

- Grade 6 support: the research card asks for two tasks and one “day in the life” line; the verdict is one sentence; the test omits items 16 and 20 (scored out of 38).
- Grade 8 stretch: the research card adds “two other careers on the same path” and “the first step I could take before high school ends”; item 20 on the test asks for two examples with numbers.
- UDL checkpoint used: multiple means of representation (the six paths as words, years, pictures, and three worked answers from the do now) and multiple means of action and expression (research on a device or a printed sheet; a verdict written or dictated).
- No-device alternative: printed career sheets for the research card; the paper trading window from Lesson 2.20 (Handout 02.19 - Paper Ledger.md and the price table).

Assessment

Objective	Standards met	Learning task	Assessment (formative or summative; tool)
1. Describe the six paths with an example job	IGLR 3. d); National FCS 1.1.6	Six-paths table, Step 1	Formative; handout front checked; summative on Unit 2 Test item 19
2. Complete a research card from a source	IGLR 5. a); CCO 4. a); CDOS 1; National FCS 1.2.1	Research card, Step 2	Summative; the career research card is the Topic 2.5 formal check, scored 0 to 4 on the checklist printed on the handout (topic assessments category)
3. Judge the fit and give a reason for and against	CCO 4. b); Std 3 PI E	Verdict on the card, Step 2	Summative; the verdict is one line of the research card checklist

The Unit 2 Test (Step 4) is summative for all five topics; see Assessment 02.2 - Unit 2 Test.md for the item map.

Homework

Finish the research card if it is not done. Due tomorrow at the start of Unit 3.

Connections

Inside the building: the guidance counselor, who issues working papers to students under 18 in New York and will recognize the research card format from the high school career plan; FACS gives guidance a class that has already researched a career, and guidance gives FACS the career resource and a visit on career day. Community: a local apprenticeship program or

union training center for a five-minute video call, because the apprenticeship path is the one students have never heard of.

Sources

- NYS Middle Level CTE FACS Content Module 01, Individual Growth and Life Readiness (nycotecenter.org, June 2018), lines 5. a) and 3. d). Copy in 02 Standards/NYS Module PDFs/.
- NYS Middle Level CTE Theme Module 01, Career and Community Opportunities, lines 4. a) and 4. b). Same folder.
- NYS Learning Standards for Health, Physical Education, and Family and Consumer Sciences (1996), Standard 3, Intermediate, FACS strand, and NYS CDOS Standard 1, Intermediate. Wording per 02 Standards/STANDARDS SOURCES - web research.md.
- National Standards for Family and Consumer Sciences Education 3.0 (LEAD FCS Education, 2018), competencies 1.2.1 and 1.1.6.
- Career research sources students use: the New York State career exploration site the guidance office recommends, and the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics Occupational Outlook Handbook (bls.gov/ooh). Pay figures on the handout example are to be refreshed before teaching and dated.
- My own materials: my packet “Education Roadmap: Paths to Your Dream Career” (Unit 2 Career Exploration, April 2026). The pathways table (duration, example careers, who pays) and Activity 2 (choose a career, name its path, plan a first step) are rebuilt as the six-paths table and the research card. The logic puzzle is dropped.

Teacher notes

- The clock is tight. The order is fixed: careers first, window second, test last, so the room is quiet and cleared when the test starts. If the window runs over by a minute, take it from Step 2, not the test. The test gets its full 15 minutes.
- Common mistake: students pick a career from a poster they liked rather than from their top three clusters. The card asks for the cluster number; check it before they open the resource.
- Common mistake two: students copy the pay figure without the year. Say “no year, no points” once.
- The one review slide before the test should be the class’s weakest topic from the four checks, not a full review. A full review is what the last three days of do nows were for.
- The last trading window closing the leaderboard on a test day is on purpose: nobody argues about standings when a test is in front of them. The Round 2 standings and two or three journal lines read aloud happen in the first 10 minutes of Unit 3 Day 1, as the unit plan and Project 02 lay out.
- Keep the research cards in the FACS folder. Unit 7 (Lesson 7.2) builds the resume objective line from them.